BY ORDER OF THE SUPERINTENDENT

HQ UNITED STATES AIR FORCE ACADEMY INSTRUCTION 36-2015

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USAFA COMMISSIONING EDUCATION

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This instruction implements AFI 36-2014, *Pre-Commissioning Programs* and CJCSI 1800.01F, *Officer Professional Military Education Policy*, and outlines the responsibilities, policies and procedures governing the cadet Commissioning Education Courses. This instruction applies to all USAFA personnel while instructing Commissioning Education materials to USAFA cadets. This publication does not apply to Air Force Reserve Command (AFRC) units and the Air National Guard (ANG). Submit recommended changes on AF Form 847**,** *Recommendation for Change of Publication*, through your chain of command to USAFA/CWVV, 2354 Fairchild Drive, Suite 2D13, USAF Academy CO 80840. The authorities to waive requirements in this publication are identified with a Tier 3 (T-3) number following the compliance statement. See AFI 33-360, *Publications and Forms Management,* for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate Tier waiver approval authority. The waiver authority for non-tiered requirement in this publication is USAFA/CWC. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System.

1. General. Commissioning Sources Institutional Competency Learning Outcomes (CICLOs) outlined in Paragraph 4 of AFI 36-2014, *Pre-Commissioning Programs,* and Pre-Commissioning requirements outlined in Appendix B to Enclosure E, CJCSI 1800.01F, *Officer Professional*

Military Education Policy, are integrated throughout the USAFA Course of Instruction as outlined in USAFAI 36-3526*, USAFA Course of Instruction & Change Control.* The achievement of these learning outcomes is the first level of the officer developmental education architecture and a prerequisite to receiving a commission in the United States Air Force. This instruction provides the framework for the authorities, organization and execution of curriculum to meet these requirements during the 47-month Air Force Academy experience.

2. Responsibilities.

2.1. **USAFA/CC, Superintendent.** The Superintendent is the supported commander for character development (Ref: USAFAMD 6, *Headquarters Staff*, Para 2.5.) and ensures:

2.1.1. The Commandant of Cadets, Dean of Faculty, and Director of Athletics will ensure character development is supported by and integrated throughout the 4-year Course of Instruction (COI) for academic, leadership, and physical development. (Ref: USAFAMD 6, *Headquarters Staff*, Para 2.5)

2.1.2. The requirements of the Chairman, Joint Chiefs of Staff, Officer Professional Military Education Policy (*CJCSI 1800.01F*) and the Air Force Pre-Commissioning Program (*AFI 36-2014*) are met.

2.2. **Chief, Curriculum Division and Senior Development Advisor to the Commandant of Cadets (USAFA/CWC).** USAFA/CWC is responsible for coordinating the collection of mission element inputs to CICLOs and works directly with the mission elements to enable this data collection and analysis. USAFA/CWC will:

2.2.1. Chair the USAFA Commissioning Training and Education Committee (CTEC). This committee provides oversight to the execution of CICLOs within the USAFA Course of Instruction.

2.2.1.1. Committee Membership is as follows.

2.2.1.1.2. USAFA/CWC (Air Force Pre-Commissioning Program Committee, PCPC) Representative (Ref: AFI 36-2014, *Pre-Commissioning Programs*).

2.2.1.1.3. USAFA/DFA (Senior Associate Dean, Air Force PCPC Representative (Ref: AFI 36-2014, *Pre-Commissioning Programs*).

2.2.1.1.4. USAFA/ADPVD

2.2.1.2. The USAFA CTEC will:

2.2.1.2.1. Advise the Superintendent, Commandant of Cadets, Dean of Faculty and Director of Athletics on issues pertaining to CICLOs.

2.2.1.2.2. Maintain and validate mission element inputs required by **paragraph 2.5.1.1**, to reduce redundancy and facilitate complementary education, training and experiences across mission elements.

2.2.1.2.3. Resolve disagreements and assign responsibilities for achievement of disputed and/or missing inputs to the CICLOs.

2.2.1.2.4. Report Air Force Academy fulfillment of the Commissioning Education Program annually to USAFA senior leadership or as requested.

2.2.1.2.5. Represent USAFA at Air Force PCPC and Pre-Commissioning Curriculum Integration Group (PCIG) meetings (Ref: AFI 36-2014, *Pre-Commissioning Programs*) on issues related to the USAFA Course of Instruction.

2.2.1.2.6. Coordinate with the USAFA Outcome Strategy Team for CELOs related to the USAFA Outcomes.

2.2.1.2.7. Ensure the changes to achievement of CICLOs are managed IAW USAFAI 36-3526, *USAFA Course of Instruction & Change Control*.

2.2.2. Host Air Force PCPC/PCIG meetings when held at USAFA.

2.3. **Commandant of Cadets (CW).** The Commandant of Cadets directs and manages military education and training programs (Ref: DoDI 1322.22, *Service Academies*), is the supported commander for cadet leadership development (Ref: USAFAMD3, *Commandant of Cadets*), and is a supporting commander for character development. Within this authority, the Commandant of Cadets will:

2.3.1. Ensure all members of CW are briefed on the relationship between the Air Force Foundational Competencies, the CICLOs and the Institutional Outcomes. CWC ensures that regular status of links between CICLOs and core course learning objectives are made available to CW directors and program managers and appropriately considered in curricular planning.

2.3.2. CW directors and program managers will ensure that their core course learning objectives linked to CICLOs have measurable assessments of individual student mastery (e.g. test/graded review/final exam questions, essays, exercises or other course-related assignments).

2.3.3. Maintain a Curriculum Division, this division will:

2.3.3.1. Manage development and administration of Commissioning Education Courses and other courses targeting achievement of CICLOs.

2.3.3.2. Publish curricular materials.

2.3.3.3. Maintain a library of commissioning education lesson plans and other curricular materials.

2.4. **Dean of Faculty (DF).** The Dean of Faculty directs and manages the development and execution of an undergraduate curriculum and is a supporting commander for character development. Within this authority, the Dean of Faculty will:

2.4.1. Ensure all members of the Faculty Council are briefed on the relationship between the Air Force Foundational Competencies, the CICLOs and the Institutional Outcomes. The Senior Associate Dean (USAFA/DFA) ensures that regular status of links between CICLOs, the institutional outcomes, and core-course learning objectives are made available to DF Department Heads and appropriately considered in curricular planning.

2.4.2. Ensure DF Department Heads brief their faculty on the relationship between the Air Force Foundational Competencies, the CICLOs and the Institutional Outcomes. Additionally, ensure the CICLOs are assessed within the appropriate institutional outcome at that the appropriate level of student competence (e.g. quiz/graded review/final exam questions, essays, exercises or subjective evaluation of other course-related assignments).

2.5. **Director of Athletics (AD).** The Director of Athletics directs and manages intercollegiate athletic programs and other physical fitness programs and is a supporting commander for character development. Within this authority, the Director of Athletics will:

2.5.1. Ensure all affected AD personnel are briefed on the relationship between the Air Force Foundational Competencies, the CICLOs and the Institutional Outcomes.

2.5.2. Ensure learning objectives that formally aligned to the CICLOs have measurable assessments of individual student mastery (e.g. test/graded review/final exam questions, essays, exercises or other course-related assignments).

2.6. **All CW, AD and DF Divisions or Departments Supporting Instruction.** These elements are the tactical units that develop curriculum and accomplish CICLOs at the Air Force Academy. As such, these units are the critical point where cadets either learn or do not learn the respective knowledge, skills or abilities expected by the United States Air Force and Department of Defense of a second lieutenant. To ensure a successful integrated effort in delivering effective curriculum, each division or department will:

2.6.1. Provide inputs to the USAFA CTEC for CICLO validation to include:

2.6.1.1. Learning/lesson objectives targeting achievement of specific CICLOs and how mastery is assessed.

2.6.1.2. All course material and evaluations must have measurable assessment of the specific CICLO. All articles of evaluation (question, essay, exercise, etc.), are subject to review.

2.6.2. Document the relationships of learning outcomes and lesson objectives to other USAFA mission elements sharing the achievement of the same learning outcome.

2.6.3. Provide updates of lesson materials to other USAFA mission elements pursuing the same learning outcomes, as requested.

2.6.4. Inform the USAFA CTEC before implementation of changes to existing curricula if they will alter inputs required by the Director of Athletics in **paragraph 2.5.1** of this document.

2.6.5. Ensure all objectives pursuing CICLOs match levels of learning specified in AFI 36-2014 and CJCSI 1800.01F.

2.6.6. Elevate issues preventing integration or causing unintentional redundancy to the USAFA CTEC, through their mission element CTEC member.

3. CICLO Validation.

3.1. Course directors/program managers will validate inputs once per year for each course participating in achieving the CICLOs.

3.2. The CTEC will produce an annual report, by 1 July, for the Commandant of Cadets, the Dean of the Faculty, and the Athletic Director summarizing the compliance with commissioning education program requirements and a statistical summary of the elements referenced in **paragraph 2.5.1** of this document.

4. Commissioning Education (CE) Course Administration.

4.1. **Program Overview:** Commissioning Education consists of four courses, one each class year, directed by the Commandant of Cadets. All Commissioning Education Courses are graduation and Commissioning requirements and must be completed by all Cadets. They are listed as CE 100, 200, 300, and 400 in the USAFA Course of Instruction Handbook. Mastery of the learning objectives is assessed via criterion-referenced, selection items on tests for each lesson.

4.2. **Attendance:** Commissioning Education class attendance is mandatory for all four-year cadets, one-semester foreign exchange students participating in the Cadet Semester Exchange Abroad Program (CSEAP), and Service Academy Exchange cadets. Cadets may only be excused during their regularly scheduled period for Airmanship programs, medical appointments, or Scheduling Committee Approved events per USAFAI 36-3536, *Allocation of Cadet Time*.

4.3. **Grading.**

4.3.1. The courses are Pass/Fail and appear on the cadets' transcripts as such. A grade of less than 75% on any exam constitutes a failure of the course. Air Officers Commanding (AOCs) should consider placing cadets who fail a second time on aptitude probation. A third failure constitutes consideration for disenrollment.

4.3.2. The first attempt at each Commissioning Education test counts toward the overall Military Performance Appraisal (MPA) score IAW USAFAI 36-2401, *Military Performance Appraisal*. Cadets who fail or miss the first exam will not have their second attempt count towards the MPA score. Cadet Squadron exam score averages will be taken into account for Outstanding Squadron calculations IAW Outstanding Squadron System instruction AFCW 36-2809.

4.4. **Remedial Instruction.**

4.4.1. Re-test times will be scheduled in the Cadet Military Training Schedule and proctored by AOCs/ Academy Military Training NCO (AMTs) for cadets who do not pass the initial Commissioning Education test. All cadets who need to re-accomplish the test must test during one of those times. Individual testing exceptions must be coordinated in advance and may be granted on a case-by-case basis for cadets in extreme circumstances. Retest scores will not be factored into the MPA.

4.4.2. Cadets who fail a second time must complete a remedial training program the following semester in addition to their scheduled class-load. They will re-test upon completion of remedial requirements. A third failure constitutes consideration for disenrollment.

4.4.2.1. Remediation requirements dictate the cadet must conduct a full review of all pertinent Commissioning Education course work and pass the retake test.

4.4.2.2. Remedial instruction will occur during cadet personal time per the Schedule of Calls.

4.4.2.3. AOCs are ultimately responsible for their cadet completing remedial training.

4.5. **Service Academy Exchange Cadets:**

4.5.1. Service Academy Exchange cadets must attend Commissioning Education, and re-test if they fail the initial exam.

4.5.2. Their first test scores will be factored in their MPA and Outstanding Squadron calculation.

4.6. **Foreign Exchange Cadets:**

4.6.1. Four-year Foreign Exchange cadets must attend Commissioning Education, and re-test if they fail the first test.

4.6.2. Their first test scores will be factored in the MPA and Outstanding Squadron calculations.

4.6.3. One-semester CSEAP cadets must attend all scheduled blocks of Commissioning Education; however, they are not restricted to only the lessons in their year group. AOCs shall direct CSEAP cadets to attend lessons that focus on concepts of leadership, officership, character or any other Commissioning Education lessons beneficial to the foreign exchange cadet. AOCs will select from any of the scheduled lessons on USAFA Commissioning Education SharePoint website (**https://eim.usafa.edu/unit/cw/ce/**).

4.7. **USAFA Exchange and Study Abroad Cadets:**

4.7.1. USAFA cadets on foreign exchange, service academy exchange, or semester study abroad programs must complete all missed Commissioning Education course work, and pass each test for the term during which they were abroad. All missed course work, and tests, will be completed no later than the initial due date for the last Commissioning Education test of the semester upon the cadet's return to USAFA.

5. Responsibilities for Commandant of Cadets Organizations.

5.1. **The Commandant of Cadets, Directorate of Training Support (CWT) will:**

5.1.1. Provide administrative support for the Commissioning Education courses.

5.2. **The Curriculum Division (CWC) will:**

5.2.1. Organize, plan and develop course material and syllabi IAW AFH 36-2235, Volume 10, *Information for Designers of Instructional Systems: Application to Education Design.* Lessons will target Learning Outcomes in AFI 36-2014, *Pre-Commissioning Programs* and fit within the framework, of USAFAPAM 36-3527, *The Officer Development System: Developing Leaders of Character.*

5.2.2. De-conflict lesson content with other mission elements and programs to ensure repetition is eliminated or has educational value for the United States Air Force that outweighs any perceived duplication.

5.2.3. Ensure lesson material is relevant, current, and accurate.

5.2.4. Utilize appropriate teaching methods in lessons plans such as informal lecture, guided discussion, and teaching interview.

5.2.5. Coordinate with agencies and subject matter experts, such as the Sexual Assault Response Coordinator, Human Resources, Inspector General, and Staff Judge Advocate to ensure lessons in those subject areas are relevant, current and accurate

5.2.6. Service Academy Exchange cadets must attend Commissioning Education, complete tests, and re-test if they fail on the initial attempt.

5.2.7. Conduct Commissioning Education In-Service Training each semester.

5.2.8. Construct test items that measure learning objectives IAW AFH 36-2235, Volume 12, *Information for Designers of Instructional Systems: Test and Measurement Handbook.*

5.2.9. Provide test results, analysis, and course feedback results in a timely manner to appropriate agencies and individuals.

5.2.10. Make archived coursework available to AOCs/AMTs who have cadets in the remedial program.

5.2.11. Coordinate with AOCs/AMTs to ensure USAFA cadets on foreign exchange, service academy exchange or semester study abroad programs complete all missed course work and tests.

5.2.12. Coordinate with Standardization and Evaluation (CWVV) to periodically publish a CW Military Curriculum Test Accountability Policy letter signed by the Vice Commandant of Cadets. See **Attachment 2** for the most current policy letter.

5.3. **Air Officers Commanding will:**

5.3.1. Be responsible for the execution of the Commissioning Education lessons within their cadet squadrons IAW USAFAI 36-3522, *Roles and Responsibilities.*

5.3.2. Ensure primary Commissioning Education instruction is provided by AOCs or AMTs. other instructors should be used only when there is a manning shortfall or to enhance lesson effectiveness based on experience and expertise (see USAFAI 36-3522, *Roles and Responsibilities*).

5.3.3. Ensure cadets do not serve as primary instructors for Commissioning Education lessons.

5.3.4. Be fully prepared to carry out effective instruction and illustrate concepts by relating operational and personal experiences. The same is expected of the AMTs.

5.3.5. Determine Commissioning Education lessons and material required for one-semester Foreign Exchange cadets. The AOC will direct lessons that pertain to leadership, officership, and character, and may choose from any lessons posted on SharePoint **https://eim.usafa.edu/unit/cw/ce/**.

5.3.6. Maintain accurate and auditable cadet attendance records.

5.3.7. Proctor remedial exams or delegate to the AMT or Associate AOC.

5.3.8. Perform remedial instruction for cadets in their squadron who have been placed into the Remedial Commissioning Education program.

5.3.9. Provide the Curriculum Division with actionable feedback on the relevance, accuracy and effectiveness of the course material.

5.3.10. Ensure the teaching environment has adequate audio/visual equipment. If needed, request audio/visual support in Fairchild classrooms from the Academic Media Director DFET (333-4755).

5. 3.

11. Ensure USAFA cadets on foreign exchange, service academy exchange, or semester study abroad programs complete all missed course work and tests.

6. Command and Control: USAFA Commandant of Cadets will exercise overall command and control of the Commissioning Education courses.

RICHARD M. CLARK, Lieutenant General, USAF
Superintendent, U.S. Air Force Academy

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References
AFH 36-2235, V10, *Information for Designers of Instructional Systems Application to Unit Training*, 31 Oct 2002
AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 22 Mar 2020
AFI 36-2014, *Pre-Commissioning Programs*, 15 July 2019
CJCSI 1800.01F, *Officer Professional Military Education Policy*, 15 May 2020
DoDI1322.22, *Service Academies*, 24 Aug 1994
USAFAI36-3522, *Roles and Responsivities*, 12 Feb 2014
USAFAI 36-3526, *USAFA Course of Instruction & Change Control*, 25 Oct 2020
USAFAMD 3, *Commandant of Cadets*, 18 July 2018
USAFAMD6, *Headquarters Staff*, 5 Jul 2017

Adopted Forms
AF847

Acronyms
AD—*Athletic Department*
AMT—*Academy Military Training NCO*
AOC—*Air Officers Commanding*
CICLO—*Commissioning Sources' Institutional Competency Learning Outcome*
CoI—*Course of Instruction*
CTEC—*Commissioning Training and Education Committee*
CW—*Commandant of Cadets*
DF—*Dean of Faculty*
MPA—*Military Performance Appraisal*
PCPC—*Pre-Commissioning Program Committee*
PCIG—*Pre-Commissioning Curriculum Integration Group*

Attachment 2

CW Military Curriculum Test Accountability Policy Letter

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
COMMANDANT OF CADETS
USAF ACADEMY COLORADO

26 May 2020

MEMORANDUM FOR USAFA/CW AOCs & AMTs

FROM: USAFA/CWV

SUBJECT: Quiz Accountability Policy

1. This policy letter addresses the following: notification of upcoming quizzes and quiz close dates, passing quizzes, and make-ups for cadets who miss a lesson.

a. Notification of upcoming quizzes and quiz close dates: All quizzes close two weeks following the lesson delivery date as indicated in the CMTS, and as shown in each cadet's Blackboard Flight Plan for Distance Learning lessons.

(1) Weekly, as applicable, CWC will notify all AOCs/AMTs via email of upcoming quizzes as well as quiz close dates for each lesson. This information is also provided to cadets via Blackboard.

b. Quizzes are CLOSED BOOK and Respondus software will be utilized to ensure quiz integrity.

c. Passing quizzes: Cadets must score a minimum of 75% to pass quizzes. The ultimate goal is student mastery of the material; therefore, two additional attempts at a retake quiz are allowed.

(1) The score from the initial attempt on the quiz will count towards MPA. The final day for quiz scores to count toward MPA is M33.

(2) For cadets not completing quizzes with a passing score by M33, there will be an additional testing period scheduled after M35.

d. Actions following failures: Cadets will notify their AOC/AMTs after two failures and meet with them to discuss the cause of repeated failures and what further action, if any, is appropriate. Cadets failing all three attempts will be placed on Aptitude Probation and considered, on an individual basis, for additional action.

e. Make-ups for missed lessons: Missed lessons should be reviewed and quizzes completed as soon as possible to keep cadets current with other associated developmental activities.

(1) Cadets on exchange and semester abroad programs will make-up missed lessons and quizzes NLT the due date for the last quiz in the semester following their return.

2. Please disseminate this information to cadets within one week of receipt.

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CLARENCE W. LUKES, Col, USAF
Vice Commandant of Cadets